

Φαινίας ὁ Ἐρέσιος

Aristotelian Philosophy in the Fragments of Phaenias of Eresus

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Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Πραγματεία](#) [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Peripatetic](#)

Phaenias of Eresus was a Greek philosopher of the 4th century BCE. He was from the city of Eresus on the island of Lesbos and was a student of Aristotle, making him a member of the early Peripatetic school. He was a contemporary and close associate of the more famous philosopher Theophrastus. The exact dates of his life are not recorded, but he was active in the later part of the century.

Phaenias was a prolific writer, though none of his works survive intact. They are known only through fragments quoted by later ancient authors. His writings demonstrate the wide-ranging interests of Aristotle's first followers. His known titles include works on history and politics, such as *The Tyrants of Sicily*; on philosophy and biography, like *On the Socratics*; on literary criticism, in *On the Poets*; and on natural science, notably a botanical treatise *On Plants*.

His historical significance lies in his role as an early disseminator of Aristotelian thought across multiple fields. Academics view his fragmentary corpus as a window into the encyclopedic scholarship of the early Peripatetic circle. He is particularly noted for his biographical and historical works, which were used as sources by later writers. While overshadowed by Theophrastus, Phaenias represents the broader intellectual activity within Aristotle's immediate school.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῆς Ἀριστοτελικῆς Φιλοσοφίας](#) · [Fragments on Aristotelian Philosophy](#) · 42 passages

Other Peripatetic Authors

- [Ἀγαθαρχίδης ὁ Κνίδιος](#) · [Agatharchides of Cnidus](#) · 4 works
- [Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς](#) · [Alexander of Aphrodisias II](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀνδρόνικος ὁ Ῥόδιος](#) · [Andronicus of Rhodes](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος](#) · [Aristo of Ceos](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀριστόβουλος ὁ Ἰουδαῖος](#) · [Aristobulus the Jewish Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀριστοκλῆς ὁ Μεσσηνίος](#) · [Aristocles of Messene](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀριστόμβροτος ὁ φιλόσοφος](#) · [Aristombrotus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος](#) · [Ariston of Ceos](#) · 1 work

- Ἀσπάσιος ὁ Περιπατητικός · [Aspasius the Peripatetic](#) · 1 work
- Βοηθὸς ὁ Σιδώνιος · [Boethus of Sidon](#) · 1 work
- Χαμαιλέων ὁ Ἡρακλεώτης · [Chamaeleon of Heraclea Pontica](#) · 2 works
- Κλέαρχος ὁ Σολεύς · [Clearchus of Soli](#) · 1 work